Rebecca Jane Brough

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EDUCATION

UC-Davis — September 2021-Present
Ph.D. in Economics

University of Virginia — May 2018
B.A. in Economics and Politics, *with highest distinction*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Labor, Public, Economic History

WORKING PAPERS

1. "Creating Career Women: Access to Teaching Jobs and Women's Long-Run Outcomes" **(JMP)**
2. "Citizenship Policy and Immigrant Women's Integration: Evidence from the 1922 Cable Act"
3. "Teacher Marriage Bars" (with Wenni Yang)
4. "Better Outcomes, Lower Costs: Evidence from Competitive Bidding in WIC" (with Grace Ortuzar)

WORKS IN PROGRESS

1. "Cash vs. In-Kind: Evidence from the Introduction of SSI and the Food Stamp Cash-Out" (with Marianne Bitler, Amelia Hawkins, and Lucie Schmidt)
2. "Multigenerational Effects of Divorce"
3. "Food Assistance Programs and the Retail Price of Food" (with Marianne Bitler)

PUBLICATIONS

1. "Refugees' Economic Integration" (with Dany Bahar and Giovanni Peri) *Journal of Economic Literature* 64.3 (2026): 950-83.
2. "Eliminating Fares to Expand Opportunities: Experimental Evidence on the Impacts of Free Public Transportation on Economic and Social Disparities" (with Matt Freedman and David Phillips) *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy* 17.3 (2025): 1-34.

3. "High Schools Tailored to Adults Can Help Them Complete a Traditional Diploma and Excel in the Labor Market" (with David Phillips and Patrick Turner) *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy* 16.4 (2024): 34-67.

4. "Experimental evidence on the effects of means-tested public transportation subsidies on travel behavior." (with Matt Freedman and David Phillips) *Regional Science and Urban Economics* 96 (2022): 103803.

5. "Can transportation subsidies reduce failures to appear in criminal court? Evidence from a pilot randomized controlled trial." (with Matt Freedman, Dan Ho, and David Phillips) *Economics Letters* 216 (2022): 110540.

6. "Understanding socioeconomic disparities in travel behavior during the COVID-19 pandemic." (with Matt Freedman and David Phillips) *Journal of Regional Science* 61.4 (2021): 753-774.

RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

Wilson Sheehan Lab for Economic Opportunities Emerging Scholar Affiliate	2025-
Global Migration Center	2024-
Center for Poverty and Inequality Research	2024-

AWARDS AND GRANTS

Russell Sage Foundation, Dissertation Grant, $15,000	2026-2027
Economic History Association, Sokoloff Award, $17,500	2026-2027
Provost Dissertation Year Fellowship, $60,000	2026-2027
Bacon Family Fellowship Award, $6,000	2025
UC Davis Travel Grant Award	2022, 2024, 2025, 2026
UC Davis Research Grant Award	2024, 2025
Emmerich-Wright Award for best undergraduate politics thesis, University of Virginia	2018

PRESENTATIONS

2026: IPUMS data conference; Southern Economic Association; Center for Poverty and Inequality Mini-Conference; All-UC Labor Conference; Bay Area History Workshop; Economic History Association (Poster); UC Davis Alumni Conference (Poster); Institute for Research on Poverty (Poster); NBER Summer Institute: Development of the American Economy (Poster)

2025: Institute for Humane Studies Workshop on Migration; Global Migration Center; Economic History Association; Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting

2024: APPAM

2023: Montana State University Applied Economics Conference; Center for Poverty and Inequality Graduate Student Retreat

RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

Professor Marianne Bitler	Aug 2025 - Present
Professor Giovanni Peri	Jun 2023 - Dec 2023; Jan 2025-Jun 2025
Professor Marianne Bitler and Marianne Page	Sep 2023 - Dec 2024
California Policy Lab, UC – Berkeley	Jun 2023 - Dec 2023
Professors Matt Freedman and David Phillips, through NBER	Dec 2022 - Mar 2023

RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Associate — Jun 2018 - Jul 2021

Wilson Sheehan Lab for Economic Opportunities (LEO), University of Notre Dame

Role: Managed a portfolio of projects evaluating anti-poverty interventions in transportation, education, health, housing, and criminal justice; helped design and implement RCTs alongside faculty and administrators

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Leader of Undergraduate Research Fellow Group	Spring 2024; Fall 2025
TA for ECN 140: Econometrics	Winter 2023
TA for ECN 130: Public Microeconomics	Spring 2023
TA for ECN 102: Analysis of Economic Data	Winter 2022; Spring 2022; Fall 2022
TA for ECN 01A: Principles of Microeconomics	Fall 2021

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: Journal of Human Resources; Journal of Urban Economics: Insights; Journal of Policy Analysis and Management; Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics

UC Davis Graduate Student Mentor — 2024-Present

REFERENCES

Professor Giovanni Peri
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Professor Marianne Bitler
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